Slippery Slopes

The snow glinted like diamonds upon the morning slope as it slowly peaked out from behind the mountains. I have never felt such intense nerves as the lift brought me higher to the highest peak. I had never been much of a skier but there was something about this girl that made me want to try everything, to reach across the world and grab whatever experience I could. Not much of a skier is also quite the understatement, I was pretty adamantly against skiing. In the 8th grade I had suffered a nasty ATV accident and since then I had sworn off all sports that involved going faster than ten miles an hour. I spent most of my time outdoors running or kayaking, two sports which severely benefit from good weather.

I had reservations when I got to the top, my mind began racing and I could feel the panic rising inside me like a covered pasta pot, bubbling to the surface, nowhere for the heat to escape. Then I saw her, no hesitation, she threw herself hurtling down the hill as though it was a walk in the park. I had always considered myself an adventurous person, always told myself that when a challenge came knocking at the door I would answer, yet here I was, frozen in the snow. I decided then to stop living the safe life I had spent too long living as J.K Rowling once wrote, “What is life without a little risk?”

That quote soon became my mantra. I barely made it down the mountain, I fell more times than I would care to admit and spent most of my time moving slower than a frozen river. I was cold, bruised, and exhausted, but at the same time, I had never felt more alive. It was exhilarating, every single aspect of it worked together to create this perfect experience, the cold, the pain, the exhaustion. It came together like chocolate and milk. It gave me courage and confidence, I felt invincible, even God’s harshest landscapes were no match for me. I never stopped, oh I would take a break from hitting the slopes, give myself enough time to go to work and to pass my classes, but I always came back harder than ever.

Eventually it started to take a toll on my life, I would cancel plans, skip assignments, call in sick. There was no satisfying my hunger, I only ever wanted more. When I wasn’t skiing, I would think of nothing else, and when I would ski, I would think of nothing at all, glorious ignorance. I lost friends, pushed away family, and isolated myself. In the end I wonder if it would have been better if I had just never started skiing in the first place, because once you hit a slippery slope, it can be impossible to climb back up.